ACTIVITY 043

Speak, Tap, Sing

Rhythm & Pulse

6 minutes / Two bars from repertoire.

Separate a rhythm problem from its pitch problem.

SPEAK

Say the rhythm

TAP

Keep the beat in your hand

SING

Restore the melody

Keep the same pulse while changing one musical ingredient at a time.

1. Speak the syllable 'ta' in the passage's rhythm while tapping the underlying beat.
2. Speak the actual words with the same rhythm, checking where syllables share a beat.
3. Add the melody at a slower tempo, preserving the spoken rhythm.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Pitch does not make the learned rhythm disappear.

COMMON TRAP

Changing the tempo when adding melody.

MAKE IT WORK

Use only one bar until the coordination is dependable.